A/B, I, 77, 1

TO: Security Officer
VIA: Deputy Security Officer
VIA: Chief, Security Research Staff, I&S
FROM: Chief, Technical Branch, SRS, I&S H
SUBJECT: Report on ARTICHOKE by [redacted], Summary of, dated 2 February 1953)
H

DATE: 16 February 1953

1. The writer has made a very careful study and analysis of the [redacted] report on the ARTICHOKE problem. In general, the writer agrees in the overall statements set out by the [redacted] group but wishes to point out certain elements in the [redacted] report that are subject to dispute and tend to indicate that the [redacted] group has not been totally informed as to the nature of ARTICHOKE or the present status of the ARTICHOKE work insofar as [illegible] ~~the Technical Branch~~ is concerned.

H

(1) The [redacted] group continually stresses long-range experimentation, particularly of a psychological and psychiatric nature. The writer agrees with this as a general premise but while conducting this long-range research it appears absolutely essential that we develop, and have ready for instant use, techniques, etc. that will or at least ~~will~~ assist in obtaining information in vital cases. The writer believes that involved, complex, and cumbersome research such as [redacted] carried on at [redacted] will not be productive (certainly in the immediate future) and is unrealistic and will not be of use to the operations people when it is needed.

C

[redacted]

(2) The [redacted] discusses the use of various chemical agents. While in a general sense ~~is~~ these statements are accurate, it does not specifically get to the core of the problem. The writer assumes that the [redacted] group is familiar with most of the few techniques but it is possible that [redacted] has never considered or possibly never heard of ~~it~~ interrogation problems, techniques and effects some. The writer believes that the [redacted] group is looking for a weapon that will make an individual talk at great length on pertinent matters while there is nothing in their report to indicate the extreme value of a chemical agent if it will produce only one small bit of verifiable information. The [redacted] comment~~s~~ that individuals when they realize they are drugged tend to become taciturn is not accurate. Individuals may become taciturn~~ed~~ under certain circumstances if they feel that they have been drugged or attempted to be druggued surrepticiously, but ~~one~~ of the established ARTICHOKE techniques is to conceal the fact of the drugging behind a medical cover and then use drugs as a medical ~~cover~~ treatment in ~~specifi~~c cases. artificially designed illnesses

(3) [redacted] discusses the use of drugs, hypnosis, and brain damaging processes and calls them "elaborate, impractical, and unnecessary" without, it appears, going into specific reasons why these processes might be used. Their comment that equivalent results could be accomplished by experts using simple techniques of interrogation. The writer does not agree with this at all and can cite instances where absolutely new information was turned up using chemicals that was unavailable before the chemicals were

used and where "expert" interrogators had attempted to obtain ~~all~~ information.

(4) [redacted] apparently supports the "textbook theory" that individuals under hypnosis will not act against their will in repugnant acts ~~of~~ violence and acts of disloyalty. This is a very moot question and the writer wishes to point out that there ~~are~~ no tests made that can be regarded as definative in this matter. The writer wishes to point out that experts in the field of hypnosis are not agreed on this point and ~~actual professors and not doct~~ors feel that there is a good chance that these things can be accomplished through hypnosis.

All H"

(5) The [redacted] group comments on methods of combating the techniques and their recommendations in general appear to the writer to be fairly ~~should~~ sound although again tests to support these recommendations would take a great deal of time, money, and effort before anything definative could come of it.

(6) [redacted] recommendations that large extensive studies be made in psychological effects, human behavior, studies of seduction, persuasion, and persistence are, undoubtedly, worthy projects but would be time consuming and results would not be forthcoming for extremely long periods of time.

RECOMMENDATIONS

2. That ~~if and~~ when the [redacted] group ever meets as a unit that ARTICHOKE Team members be permitted to talk personally to the [redacted] group members and lay before them specific examples and certain items which possibly the [redacted] members can give pertinent advice. The writer

(particularly operational work)

feels that the [redacted] group has never been thoroughly briefed or indocrinated in ARTICHOKE AND THAT their report quite clearly reflects that.

H

3. The writer cannot agree with the [redacted] opinion that "little threat, if any, to National Security exists because of special interrogation techniques or agents." The writer wishes to point out that ~~the~~ it only requires one break for the successful compromising of one individual to cause extreme damage to a nation. There are numerous recent classic examples of this.

H

[redacted] does not touch upon the study of ways & means of making individuals

1. less efficient, lazy, sloppy etc
2. Fogging memory permanently
3. Confusion
4. Reorientation - or re-adjusting think (and particularly the so called "brain washing")
5. The problem of what to do with the body after chemicals have been used